Breathing Room: Team handoff for Pauline (12 Oct)

Oct 12, 2026 · @Marcus

Where we are

The full money path now runs end to end on real services in sandbox mode: bank → collection → pot → Chainlink → fair split → pound bank transfer to the creditor. Only one step is simulated: turning pounds into tokens on the way into the pot.

Submission deadline: Oct 14, 2026, 04:59 UK time (13 Oct, 11:59pm US Eastern). Team: Kayah, Pauline, Obi, Mjetson.

Live app: breathing-room-peach.vercel.app (raw, pre-UX). Jay is building the skeleton from his Phase 1 wireframes.

What changed since 7 Oct

Date	What	Notes
12 Oct	Creditors paid in pounds via Revolut	First sandbox payout: £12.40 to "Lambeth Council", ref PCN LB123456. Creditor step now asks for sort code, account no., reference and postal address
12 Oct	KIMI wired for appeal letters	Key on the server, model kimi-k2.6. Account needs a top-up; letters fall back to a template until then
12 Oct	Unit economics + pitch correction doc	Costs, revenue models, scale scenarios, corrected pitch lines
12 Oct	Modulr researched as the production payments partner	Docs confirm per-user safeguarded accounts, Direct Debit/VRP, Faster Payments with reference (needs "Partner" access)

Date	What	Notes
11 Oct	Jay's feedback applied	Real appeal grounds, right law per notice type, auto-SFS from bank (3-month average), deficit budget routes to advisers
11 Oct	Skeleton handoff for Jay	Every screen, its data and states, and answers to his 5 questions
9 Oct	Chainlink automation moved to the server	Runs every 2 minutes on the droplet, not on Kayah's Mac
9 Oct	Collection providers	GoCardless Direct Debit and TrueLayer Open Banking (VRP) both live in sandbox
8 Oct	Open Banking	TrueLayer bank link for payday detection; collects only the surplus, essentials stay in the bank
8 Oct	Chainlink automation proven on-chain	First automatic payout with no button pressed
7 Oct	App put online + crypto made invisible	Email-only login, £ balances, no wallet words; each tester gets their own pot

Problems we hit and how they were solved

Problem	What we did
Chainlink retired classic Automation for testnets	Migrated to Chainlink CRE, their replacement. Chainlink told us deploying to their network is commercial; for hackathons they recommend the simulator, which we run with live on-chain broadcast
The original SWOT said "zero custody sidesteps the FCA"	Wrong at the edges: collecting and paying out pounds is regulated. Corrected the pitch; production uses a licensed partner (Modulr) where each user gets a safeguarded account

Problem	What we did
Nothing paid creditors in real pounds	Built the payout layer: each on-chain payout becomes one Revolut bank transfer with the creditor's reference
TrueLayer Payments/VRP looked sales-gated	Sweeping VRP (between the user's own accounts) works without sales. GoCardless Direct Debit added as a second option
The demo used a made-up rate (£1 = 0.00001 MON)	MON is a floating coin, about £0.016 on the real market, not a stablecoin. Plan: a test pound token so every amount is real pounds
Appeal letters showed developer text and argued nothing	Rewrote the letter engine; reasons no longer hidden behind the health-consent box
Collection could overdraw or bounce for people living paycheck to paycheck	Designed fix: check the live balance and only take what's spare, per payment, up to a monthly target (not built yet)
Kayah's Mac corrupts large file writes (likely failing RAM)	Builds run on Vercel and the server instead; Apple Diagnostics still to run
Wise's sandbox moved and needs partner credentials	Switched to Revolut Business sandbox, which is self-serve
Modulr's sandbox form rejects Gmail addresses	Needs a business email (see open questions)

Real vs simulated

Step	Status
Bank link + payday detection (TrueLayer)	Real, sandbox
Collecting the surplus (GoCardless / TrueLayer VRP)	Real, sandbox
Pounds into tokens (on-ramp)	**Simulated**: our server sends test MON at a made-up rate
The pot and the fair split (Monad)	Real, testnet

Step	Status
Automatic trigger (Chainlink CRE)	Real workflow, run by Chainlink's simulator on our server
Creditor paid in pounds (Revolut)	Real, sandbox
AI-written appeal letters (KIMI)	Template until the KIMI account is topped up

Pitch lines to use:

- "The plan, the split and the receipts live in a pot the user owns. The bank connections at each end run through FCA-regulated partners."
- "Chainlink's CRE workflow checks every 2 minutes and pays out automatically, run in Chainlink's simulator with live broadcast, as Chainlink recommends for hackathons."
- "Free for people in debt. Creditors fund it with a share of repayments, the same model that funds StepChange."

Don't say: "zero custody", "sidesteps the FCA", "pays instantly", or anything implying real pounds are held on-chain today.

Open questions and decisions

1. **Pound-token pot before the deadline?** It replaces the fake MON rate so every amount is real pounds. A few hours' work across contract, app, Chainlink and payouts. Fallback: submit with MON and call the rate a placeholder.
2. **KIMI top-up.** Who tops up the Kimi account, and how much? The hackathon has no free KIMI credits; the $3k is a prize only.
3. **Business email for Modulr.** Their form rejects Gmail. Options: an address on a domain we own (e.g. via free Cloudflare email forwarding on sskmusic.com), or a team member's work email.
4. **Mentor messages.** The hackathon dashboard shows 2 unread on the Mentors tab. Someone should read them today; they may change the pitch.
5. **v1 scope** (from Jay): council PCNs only, or private parking, council tax and creditor debts too?
6. **Crisis handoff** (from Jay): blocking takeover or dismissible banner?
7. **Production partner.** Approach Modulr for a Partner agreement, and ask Kayah's Incard contact whether they offer embedded accounts.

8. **Debt-advice regulation.** Which charity do we approach for a white-label pilot, so the advice sits under their FCA permission?

Next steps before the deadline

- [ ] Read the 2 mentor messages on the hackathon dashboard (anyone, today)
- [ ] Decide on the pound-token pot; if yes, Kayah gives the go-ahead and Claude builds it
- [ ] Top up the Kimi account so appeals are AI-written (Kayah)
- [ ] Full rehearsal: budget → connect Mock Bank → approve Direct Debit → check for payday → watch Chainlink pay → check the Revolut transfer; collect every receipt link (team)
- [ ] Record the demo video, with a backup take (team)
- [ ] Update the pitch deck and demo script with the corrected lines and the unit economics (Pauline?)
- [ ] Fill in the hackathon submission page: tracks and bounties (Consumer Products, Privy, Chainlink CRE, KIMI), repo, video, description (team)
- [ ] Submit before 14 Oct, 04:59 UK time

After the hackathon: Modulr Partner sandbox, the balance-check collection fix, a contract security audit, and the charity pilot conversation.

Key links and facts

What	Where
Live app	breathing-room-peach.vercel.app
Backend API	breathing-api.178-62-45-130.sslip.io (Kayah's server)
Code	GitHub sskmusic7/breathing-room (private). This week's work is on branch cre-migration-and-demo, **not yet pushed or merged**
Pitch & demo script	doc
Unit economics + corrected pitch	doc

What	Where
How the money moves (explainer + diagram)	doc
Jay's skeleton handoff	doc
Main pot (DebtPots)	0x40f91DAdb62d2186669CA1F4388A782240d9c111 on Monad testnet
Chainlink bridge (AutomationReceiver)	0x95f9aA834e0e9B9930B3a6ebE63053143BE2245f
Demo test bank login (TrueLayer Mock Bank)	john / doe
GoCardless sandbox test account	sort code 200000, account 55779911

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